

New Generation English Test

Academic Entrance Diagnostic

Level	C2 - Proficiency Diagnostic
Skills assessed	Reading, Listening, Writing, Speaking, Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Format	Academic entrance diagnostic test

Reading

Proficiency, judgement and the problem of excessive language

At the highest levels, language proficiency is rarely a matter of knowing more grammar in a simple quantitative sense. The learner's challenge becomes rhetorical: choosing how direct to be, deciding which implication can be left unstated, recognising when precision becomes pedantry, and when fluency begins to conceal vagueness. A speaker may produce complex sentences and still fail to sound intellectually controlled if every idea is overstated or every qualification is treated as a decorative flourish.

This is why advanced diagnostics should not merely ask whether a structure is correct. Correctness remains necessary, but it is no longer sufficient. The stronger question is whether the language is proportionate to the situation. A complaint to an institution, an academic response, a seminar intervention and a personal reflection may all require accurate grammar, yet they demand different degrees of compression, tact and explicitness. The advanced learner must therefore demonstrate not just range, but restraint.

Task design can distort this judgement. A simplistic prompt may reward speed while concealing weak interpretation; an excessively academic prompt may reward familiarity with a genre rather than genuine control. A responsible C2 diagnostic uses several lenses: dense reading, layered listening, extended writing, spontaneous speaking and grammar items that test judgement as well as form. It should ask not only whether an answer is correct, but whether it is purposeful, responsive to context and stylistically mature.

The best feedback at this level sounds less like a verdict and more like an editorial conversation. It notices when complexity becomes ornament, when caution becomes evasion, and when fluency loses precision. It does not punish ambition, but it asks the learner to choose. At C2, excellence is often the capacity to use less language more exactly.

01	What is the main claim about highest-level proficiency? A. It is mainly vocabulary quantity. B. It removes the need for accuracy. C. It depends on rhetorical judgement, not just more grammar.
02	When can fluency become a problem? A. When it is too slow. B. When it uses simple words. C. When it conceals vagueness.
03	Why is correctness insufficient? A. Correctness is irrelevant. B. Grammar cannot be assessed. C. Different contexts require different rhetorical choices.
04	What does proportionate language mean? A. The longest possible answer. B. Language without nuance. C. Language suited to situation and purpose.
05	What can a simplistic prompt conceal? A. Excellent handwriting. B. Fast reading only. C. Weak interpretation.

06	What risk does an excessively academic prompt create? A. It makes grammar impossible. B. It removes vocabulary. C. It may reward genre familiarity rather than control. _____
07	What should C2 grammar items test? A. Only spelling. B. Only speed. C. Judgement as well as form. _____
08	What does editorial conversation imply? A. A final punishment. B. A casual chat without standards. C. Precise developmental feedback. _____
09	What does complexity becomes ornament mean? A. All complex language is wrong. B. Ornament improves clarity. C. Complex language used decoratively rather than purposefully. _____
10	What is excellence at C2 often described as? A. Speaking as fast as possible. B. Avoiding all risk. C. Using less language more exactly. _____

Listening

Seminar exchange on advanced assessment

Audio track: open this level on the website and press Play audio: female / male voices. The transcript is not printed in the student PDF.

01 What does advanced assessment over-reward?

- A. Silence.
 - B. Short answers only.
 - C. Visible complexity.
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02 What can complexity imitate?

- A. Pronunciation.
 - B. Attendance.
 - C. Thought.
-

03 What is the subtle difference about position?

- A. Avoiding any position.
 - B. Changing the topic.
 - C. Qualifying a position without becoming vague.
-

04 What should the writing prompt require?

- A. Only copying.
 - B. A list of definitions.
 - C. Judgement rather than summary.
-

05 Which grammar areas are named?

- A. Alphabet and numbers.
 - B. Only present simple.
 - C. Concession, inversion, reduced clauses and register.
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06	Why is diagnosis partly editorial? A. It ignores grammar. B. It is only about punctuation. C. It checks whether language does the right work.
07	What is meant by flattening meaning? A. Improving precision. B. Adding evidence. C. Losing nuance while simplifying.
08	What is the speaker's attitude? A. Dismissive of advanced learners. B. Opposed to testing. C. Demanding but principled.

Writing

[illegible]

Speaking

Record 4 minutes as if responding in an academic interview. Compare two views of advanced assessment: one based on measurable accuracy, the other on rhetorical judgement. Include concession, counterexample, and a final refined position.

Record your answer on the website or prepare an audio file for the teacher.

Preparation notes

Grammatical Range and Accuracy

01 Visible complexity may be impressive, ____ it is not necessarily precise.

- A. despite
 - B. whereby
 - C. yet
-

02 Were the prompt simplified too far, it ____ weak interpretation.

- A. will conceal
 - B. concealed
 - C. would conceal
-

03 The learner sounded fluent, if ____ evasive.

- A. some
 - B. something
 - C. somewhat
-

04 No sooner ____ a position than he qualified it.

- A. he stated
 - B. he had stated
 - C. had he stated
-

05 The issue is not so much accuracy ____ rhetorical control.

- A. than
 - B. but
 - C. as
-

06	Complexity should be treated as useful ____ purposeful. A. despite it is B. whereby it C. provided it is _____
07	The feedback, ____ severe, was productive. A. despite B. whereas C. though _____
08	A sentence may be correct without ____ appropriate. A. be B. to be C. being _____
09	It is crucial that register ____ assessed explicitly. A. is B. will be C. be _____
10	The task requires judgement, ____ mere summary. A. instead to B. whereas C. rather than _____

11	Had the learner used fewer qualifiers, the argument ____ stronger. A. might sound B. will sound C. might have sounded _____
12	The phrase was precise, ____ slightly pedantic. A. despite B. whereby C. albeit _____
13	Not only ____ the claim, but she refined it. A. she defended B. she did defend C. did she defend _____
14	The prompt was designed ____ evasive answers. A. exposing B. expose C. to expose _____
15	The response lacked the restraint ____ C2 writing often requires. A. who B. where C. that _____

16	The more advanced the learner, ____ subtle the feedback must be. A. more B. most C. the more _____
17	The argument was not wrong; ____, it was underdeveloped. A. despite B. whereby C. rather _____
18	A diagnostic should account ____ register and implication. A. about B. of C. for _____
19	The sentence was revised without ____ its nuance. A. to lose B. lose C. losing _____
20	The speaker avoided commitment, ____ weakening the answer. A. whereas B. despite C. thereby _____

21	Useful ____ the framework is, it has limits. A. despite B. whereas C. though _____
22	The learner's control appears ____ under timed conditions. A. having improved B. to improving C. to have improved _____
23	The distinction is subtle, ____ pedagogically significant. A. despite B. whereas C. yet _____
24	The answer was proportionate ____ the task. A. for B. with C. to _____
25	If feedback becomes too general, it ____ diagnostic value. A. would have lost B. had lost C. loses _____

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The evaluator asked whether the register ____ the purpose.

A. has served

B. is serve

C. served
